

Field Guide

For clan stewards & field officers — Version 3, October 2026

How to use the app in the field: logging in, registering and monitoring, mapping, disturbance checks, and sending your data. The app works **offline** — record anything with no signal and it uploads later.

1 Logging in

The app uses your **fingerprint** to identify you — no username or password.

- Open the app from the **home-screen icon** (not a browser tab).
- Tap to log in and use your enrolled finger. If it fails, press firmly and hold; after three tries wait a moment and try again.
- If you are completely locked out, your coordinator must re-enrol you.

The app works **offline**. You can record everything with no signal; it saves to the phone and uploads later when you have internet.

If a **"Check your phone's date"** warning appears when you log in, your phone's date or time is wrong, and every record you collect would be stamped with the wrong date. Open **Settings** → **Date & Time** and turn on **Automatic / Network-provided** date & time, then tap **"I've fixed it — re-check."** Do this *before* collecting any data.

If the app ever stops you from working — a warning won't clear, something is broken — don't lose your time. Tap **Report a Problem** (on your **Profile**, or on the warning itself), write what happened, and **attach a screenshot** (take one with power + volume-down first). It saves even with no signal and reaches the coordinator with your next **Send Data**, so they can help and your work isn't lost.

2 How monitoring works — register first, then monitor

Most things you monitor go through two stages:

1 Register it once.

Walk to the water source, facility, instrument or tree, and record its type, location (GPS) and a reference photo. It is then **Pending Approval**.

2 Monitor it monthly.

After your coordinator approves it and assigns it to **your clan**, it appears as a task. You take the monthly reading.

You only see your own clan's approved items. If something belongs to another clan, it will not appear on your phone — that is deliberate, so two clans don't both monitor (and get paid for) the same thing. Each item can be read **once per clan per month**; after you record it, it shows **"Done this month."**

Every registration and every monthly reading needs a **photo**.

3 Water Quality

Open **Water Quality** from the dashboard.

- **Manage Water Sources** → register a new source (name, type, GPS, photo, description). Types are grouped:
 - **Natural:** River, Creek, Spring
 - **Engineered / manmade:** Reservoir & pipes, Ram pump, Solar pump, Well / borehole
- Your clan's **approved** sources appear as monitoring tasks. Tap a *Due* one, walk to it (the app unlocks within 30 m and asks for a fingerprint), then **Begin Reading**.

What you record depends on the type:

- **River:** water observations (colour, odour, flow, pollution) **plus a Secchi disc** depth reading.
- **Creek:** water observations **plus pond skaters** (surface insects — more usually means healthier water) **and shading** over the water.
- **Spring:** the core water observations.
- **Engineered (reservoir / pump / well):** a two-part check —
 - **Source condition:** is water present/flowing, is it clean & clear, any contamination signs.
 - **Delivery & infrastructure:** water at the tap/outlet, leaks, damage to pipes/tank/pump, and any repair needed.

Always finish with a **photo** of the source today.

4 Service Delivery Monitoring (schools & health)

Open **Service Delivery Monitoring**.

- **Manage Facilities** → register a school, health centre or aid post (name, type, GPS, photo, description) → Pending Approval.
- Your clan's approved facilities appear as tasks. Tap one to record a visit.

The visit form records whether the facility was **open / partial / closed, staff present**, and:

- **Schools:** total **students present** today.
- **Health centres / aid posts:** whether **essential medicines** are in stock.

Add notes and a **photo** of the facility today, then submit.

5 Weather Station / Met instruments

Open **Weather Station**.

- **Manage Met Stations** → register an instrument (name/location, type, GPS, photo). Types: **Rain gauge, Weather station, Water level meter**.
- Your clan's approved instruments appear as tasks. Tap one to record.

The reading form is centred on **equipment function**:

- Is the instrument **working / faulty / not working**? Any **damage** (none / minor / major)?
- **Rain gauge:** rainfall since last reading (mm), and whether you emptied the gauge afterwards.
- **Water level meter:** level at the marker (cm) and flow condition.
- **Weather station:** both of the above.

Add notes and a **photo**, then submit.

6 Phenology (monitored trees)

Open **Phenology Monitoring**.

Establish a plant (**Manage Plots** → establish → crop, GPS, photo → Pending Approval). When you establish it you must **mark the plant** so the same one is found every month:

- **Okari & Massoy (trees)** — with a project staff member present, **paint a band** at chest height on the trunk, and record the **DBH** (trunk diameter at 1.3 m) as the baseline. **Re-measure the DBH once a year.**
- **Vanilla, Cocoa, Coffee (cash crops)** — attach a **numbered metal tag** (= the Plant #) that does not harm the plant (a loose tie, not a nail).
- A **photo is required** at establishment for every plant.

Monthly observation. Once approved and assigned to your clan, plants appear under **Begin Monthly Observations**. For each plant:

- Tap **every phenophase present now** — you can select several at once — across **Leaves** (budburst, young, mature, colored/falling, bare), **Flowers** (buds, open) and **Fruit** (unripe, ripe, recent drop).
- Set **overall health** (good / fair / poor).
- **Trees:** enter a new **DBH** only on the annual re-measure (otherwise leave it blank).
- Add a **photo only if there is something to report**; add notes.

As with everything else, you only see **your clan's** approved trees, so two clans don't both claim the same tree.

7 Field Mapping & Observations

Open **Field Mapping** (also reached from the **Observations** and **Garden Mapping** tiles — they all open the same screen). Use it to record **anything you see**: a problem, an event, or something to map.

Pick what you're mapping:

- **Point** — one spot (pest/disease, forest fire, landslide, fallen tree, non-compliance, social unrest, wildlife, hunting, cultural event...).
- **Line** — walk a route (a road/track).
- **Area / garden** — walk a **closed boundary**; the app gives the **area in hectares**. Choose the **Cash-crop garden** category and the crop picker appears (vanilla / coffee / cocoa / okari / massoy).

Choose a **category**, add a **title**, a short **description**, and a **photo**, then **Save**. Your GPS is captured automatically. It saves offline and **uploads with your next Send Data** — no separate file is made. (In the recent-maps list each record has an **Export** button if you ever need a KML to share.)

8 Disturbance verification

Open **Disturbance Alerts**. A *disturbance* is a sudden change — a big **fire**, a **landslide**, or a **forest clearance over 2 ha** — flagged from satellite or reported, and routed to your clan to check on the ground.

- Walk to the site (it unlocks within ~50 m and asks for your fingerprint).
- Record what you found: **confirmed** / **not found** / **inconclusive** / **couldn't reach** — and the likely **cause** separately (natural / human / unclear). Report what you *see*; don't pre-judge.
- Take a **photo** and add the area. You are only ever sent disturbances already big enough to need checking — there's no "does it count" decision to make.

9 Handover & Distribution (field officers & staff)

For **field officers** and **Project / MCF & Zone staff** who hand out items. The tile appears only for those roles.

Open **Handover & Distribution** and record each handover **as it happens**:

- **Who received them** — name or group, recipient **type** (individual, clan group, women's / youth group, school, cooperative...), and clan. If they are an **enrolled steward/officer**, add their **MCA ID**; for a group, record **who physically received** them.
- **Purpose** — pick a category (conservation planting, agroforestry, livelihood, training support, relief...) and describe it.
- **Items** — add each item with its **quantity and unit** (seeds, seedlings, tools, equipment, materials, PPE...). Tap **Add another item** for more.
- **Evidence** — a **handover photo**, a **receipt photo**, and a **short video (10–20 seconds)** of the items and the recipient receiving them.
- Tick **Recipient confirmed receipt**, then **verify your fingerprint** to submit.

GPS, the date and your identity are captured automatically as proof. It saves offline and uploads with **Send Data**. **Keep the video short** so it uploads on slow signal.

10 Sending your data

Open **Send Data**.

- **Send All New Records** uploads everything not yet sent (needs signal).
- If there's no direct signal, the app can open the Android **share sheet** so you can send the backup file to your coordinator via WhatsApp, or transfer it by USB. Your coordinator uploads it to Drive.
- **Storage Health** should show "**Data is protected.**" If it says *NOT protected*, the app was opened from a browser tab — reinstall it from the home-screen icon (ask your coordinator).

Your data is safe while the phone has space and the app is installed to the home screen. Send your records whenever you find signal so nothing is lost if the phone is damaged.

11 Getting around

- The phone's **back button** moves **back one screen** in the app (it no longer jumps out and loses your place). The ← at the top-left does the same.
- Pulling down to refresh no longer reloads the app, so you won't be bounced to the login screen by accident.
- The **Home / Map / Alerts / Profile** bar is along the bottom. Coordinators/project staff reach **MCF Summary** and **Coordinator Tools** from **Profile**.

12 Quick reference

Task	Where
Log in	Fingerprint on the opening screen
Register a new thing	<i>Manage ...</i> button inside its module
Do a monthly reading	Tap a <i>Due</i> item in the module's task list
See only my clan's work	Automatic — others' items are hidden
Send data	Send Data → Send All New Records
Check data is protected	Send Data → Storage Health